

Sign language to text

Researchers from the Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS) and Microsoft Research Asia have developed a device that can live-translate sign language into text

software programmable buttons (Express Keys) on the top. The scope area can be resized using the driver software. The actual sensitive area is covered by a transparent plastic sheet to reduce the friction with the pen tip while drawing – and hence the extra pen tips as back-up.



The mouse

The wireless mouse bundled along with it is lightweight and has good response in all applications, except games. The scroll wheel is a button and doesn't really turn.

Drawing performance

PF1209 performs really well. There's no lag between the pen and the brush cursor in the software. Pressure sensitivity with 1024 levels feels like a hard-tipped brush. But tilt angle is a restraint and can annoy you at times. The big active area saves you from panning the workspace often. A nifty feature that's missing is the eraser tip on the back of the pen. Another thing to notice is the little roughness that you feel while colouring, which requires a lot of scrubbing on the tablet. The battery lasts for more than 2 months with a daily usage of 2-3 hrs.

Verdict

PF1209 is definitely the best buy for those who are looking for alternatives of WACOM. Just make sure you got ample space on your table and in your travel bag.

Amazing Spiderman (PC)

The *Amazing Spiderman* is a third-person open world action game. In it, you control obviously the friendly neighborhood Spiderman. The game takes you forward from the movie. The game starts five months after the movie's happenings.

Oscorp Industries is now in control of Alistair Smythe, a brilliant scientist who specializes in creating nanobots – robots that can only be seen by a microscope. He reveals that some of Oscorp scientists are still working on the cross-species experiments, and he also tells Gwen Stacy that all the experiments are being shifted for disposal. Peter Parker, being a good boyfriend, wants to go with Gwen to take the experiments for disposal.

Everything goes haywire when one of the cross-species detect Peter as one of their own (a radioactive spider bit Peter to give him the powers of a spider). When the cross-species try to kill Gwen, the security protocol gets enabled. All the robots spread in the city and start to kill all the cross-species including our very own amazing Spiderman, and what's worse is that the cross-species are also trying to kill Spidey. The game has a good start, with a catchy storyline that



Tarun Dhawan

SwiftKey beta is out

SwiftKey has added a new feature called 'SwiftKey Cloud' which will allow the app to sync everything it learns across all your various devices using it

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keeps you gripped, and you want to play more. The graphics are quite nice. Although what I did not like is the camera. It kills the interest in the action. The camera gets out of control when you're fighting, and that's mostly very annoying.

The best thing that you notice is that when you're web swinging, the background rushes by making the game look lively and realistic. The worst part of the web slinging is that you can only throw a web when you're falling down, not when you're moving forward. The game is not as good as previous Spiderman games such as *Spiderman Shattered Dimensions*, or *Spiderman Web of Shadows*. Also what I would have liked is that the game kind of loses interest for the people who haven't seen the movie – there should've been a small cut scene before the game started.

The fighting sequences have been made to look like they've been picked up directly from the Arkham series. There's no health bar, so you don't know how much of your health remains. There's no health updates, no health kits or anything that replenishes your health. So because of this you end up dying most of the time.

I thought this game could do what the Arkham series did to Batman, but alas it didn't work as well as can be seen. I give the game 3/5. 

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